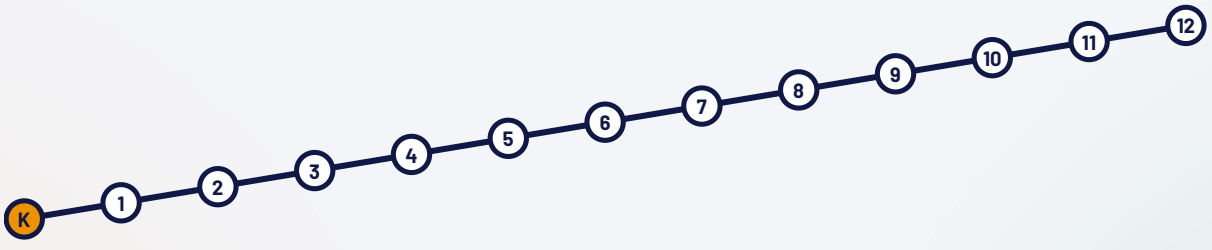
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

Our Curriculum Journey: ELA

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12, with questions and options for our part in the story.



These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade (2,709 ratings, completed November 2026), not what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

Contents

1	**ELA, K-12** English Language Arts from Kindergarten to Grade 12.	3
2	**About the data (at the back)** Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, and the limits.	15

Each part follows the same path: the picture (charts), what the numbers say, what we notice, questions for us, and our part in the story (options for improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). The data behind each item is shown in brackets, and each item links to the matching page of the Vertical Alignment site. About the data (where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use and the limits) is at the back. 18 pages, A4. The bookmarks jump to each part.

Taught in depth Introduced / exposed Not taught

ELA, KINDERGARTEN TO GRADE 12

ELA, K-12

Across K-12, teachers reported that 79% of the 652 ELA ratings (562 standards) are at least introduced, the widest coverage of any subject, and 35% are taught in depth. ELA accounts for more than half of all the in-depth teaching in the school, and Science and Social Studies carry more literacy teaching than these ratings show.

35%
taught in depth

79%
at least introduced

21%
not taught

652
grade-level ratings

What you are seeing. Four headline figures for this part: the share taught in depth, at least introduced and not taught, and how many ratings they come from.

What it adds to our story. This is the starting picture for this part. The slides that follow show where these numbers come from and what they might mean for us.

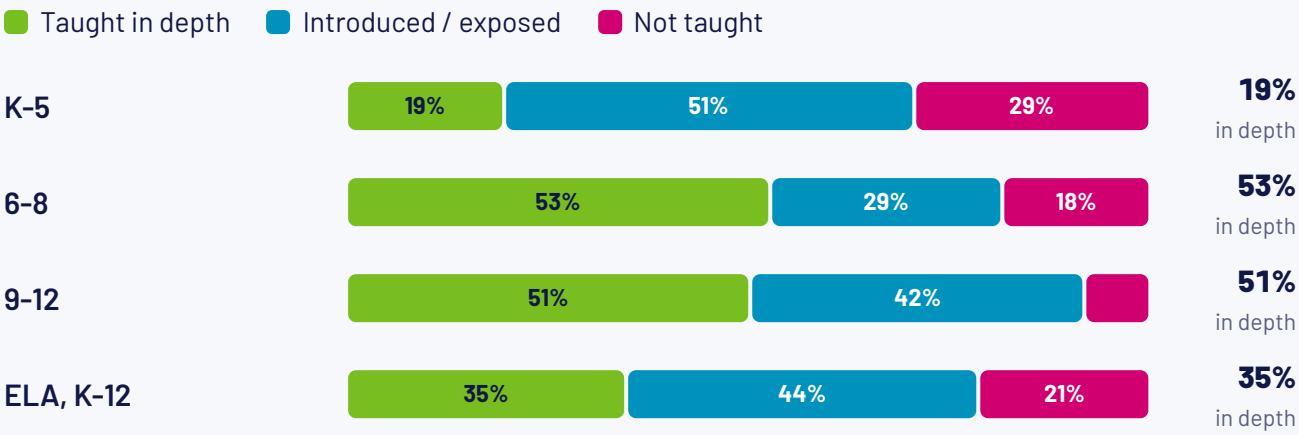
These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

THE PICTURE

At a glance

What you are seeing. Each bar shows all the ratings for one subject: green is taught in depth, blue is introduced, pink is not taught.

What it adds to our story. ELA has the widest coverage and the most depth of any subject.



How to read this: each bar is 100% of the grade-level ratings. Green is taught in depth, blue is introduced or exposed, pink is not taught. Essential Elements are counted apart.

Open the coverage map on the site ↗

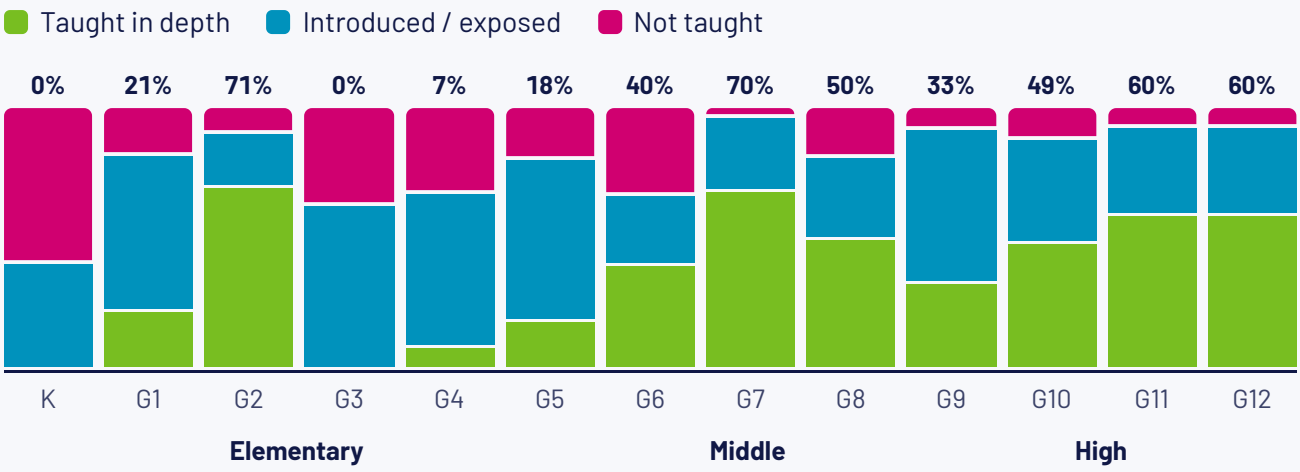
	Rated	In depth	Introduced	Not taught
K-5	**340**	**19%**	**51%**	**29%**
6-8	**132**	**53%**	**29%**	**18%**
9-12	**180**	**51%**	**42%**	**8%**
K-12	**652**	**35%**	**44%**	**21%**

THE PICTURE

Grade by grade

What you are seeing. One column for each grade. The number on top is the share of that grade's standards taught in depth.

What it adds to our story. ELA grows strongly from K-5 into secondary, with a few grades that rated more cautiously.

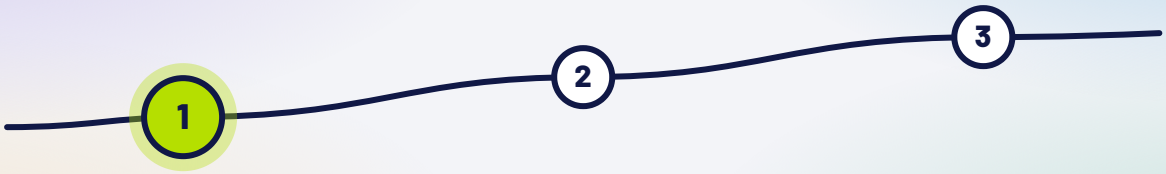


How to read this: one column per grade. The number on top is the share taught in depth.

Strand	K	G1	G2	G3	G4	G5	G6	G7	G8	G9	G10	G11	G12
Language	0%	0%	31%	0%	0%	29%	33%	62%	43%	54%	15%	27%	27%
Reading	0%	33%	78%	0%	22%	11%	33%	89%	33%	22%	67%	78%	78%
Reading Foundational Skills	0%	38%	80%	0%	0%	0%							
Speaking and Listening	0%	38%	88%	0%	13%	13%	50%	63%	63%	38%	38%	100%	100%
Writing	0%	8%	100%	0%	8%	15%	46%	69%	62%	15%	77%	60%	60%

How to read this: each square is the share of that strand's rated standards taught in depth in that grade. Darker green means more in depth. A blank square means the grade has no standards in that strand.

Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗



SECTION 1 OF 3

Key facts

What you are seeing. The main facts from the ratings, in plain numbers. Each one links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

What it adds to our story. Reading, writing and talk are strengths. Language (grammar and vocabulary) is the thread to strengthen, and much of it may be taught in other subjects.

1. THE BIG PICTURE **Depth by grade.** K 0%, G1 21%, G2 71%, G3 0%, G4 7%, G5 18%, G6 40%, G7 70%, G8 50%, G9 33%, G10 49%, G11 60%, G12 60%. Coverage map ↗
2. THE BIG PICTURE **Three peaks.** Grade 2 (71%), Grade 7 (70%) and Grades 11 and 12 (60%). Coverage map ↗
3. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Grade 2 in detail.** Writing 100% in depth, Speaking and Listening 88%, Reading Foundational Skills 80%, Reading 78%. Grade 2 dashboard ↗
4. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Grade 7 in detail.** Reading 89%, Writing 69%, Speaking and Listening 63%, Language 62%. Grade 7 dashboard ↗
5. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Strands by band, share in depth.** Reading 24%, 52%, 61%. Writing 22%, 59%, 54%. Speaking and Listening 25%, 58%, 69%. Language 10%, 45%, 30%. Coverage map ↗
6. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Reading Foundational Skills (K–5 only).** 25% in depth: 38% in Grade 1, 80% in Grade 2, and 0% from Grade 3 to Grade 5. Coverage map ↗
7. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Kindergarten.** No standard is yet rated in depth, and 60% are not taught; this is where reading and writing begin. Language is 93% not taught and Reading 78%. Every Speaking and Listening standard is introduced. Kindergarten dashboard ↗

8. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Progressions.** Across K-12, 21 of 33 anchor-standard progressions break down at some step and 4 are taught at every step. In high school alone, 21 of 29 are taught at every step. Progressions ↗

9. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Progression findings.** 101 in ELA, the most of any subject, 50 of them on official links. Grades 6 and 7 have 17 each. Progressions ↗

10. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Hand-overs.** 19 standards taught in depth build on an earlier-school standard rated not taught: 10 from K-5 into 6-8, 7 from 6-8 into 9-12, and 2 from K-5 into 9-12. All 19 rest on suggested links, not official ones, so each is worth checking first. Progressions ↗

11. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **In depth in more than one grade.** 34 high school standards are in depth in 2 grades of their band. Coverage map ↗

12. PRIORITY AND POWER STANDARDS **Priority and power standards.** 38% in depth K-12: 18% in K-5, 68% in 6-8, 54% in 9-12. Grade 8 priorities are 86% in depth. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

13. ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS **Essential Elements.** 48% in depth across 567 ratings: 46% in K-5, 57% in 6-8, 44% in 9-12. Coverage map ↗

14. GAPS AND PLACEMENT **Standards no grade teaches.** 128 confirmed: 100 in K-5, 24 in 6-8, 4 in 9-12. Language has 50 of them and Reading 29. Gaps and repetition ↗

15. GAPS AND PLACEMENT **Introduced, never in depth.** 241 standards are introduced and never in depth: 174 in K-5, 38 in 6-8, 29 in 9-12. Language has 84 and Writing 59. Gaps and repetition ↗



SECTION 2 OF 3

Relevant patterns

What you are seeing. What we notice when we put the facts side by side: rises, dips and comparisons. These are possibilities to talk about, not conclusions.

What it adds to our story. ELA shows what steady building across grades looks like, and that literacy also lives in Science and Social Studies.

1. THE BIG PICTURE **ELA is the school's success story in the making.** Depth roughly triples from K-5 (19%) to secondary (53% and 51%), and "not taught" shrinks from 29% to 8%. By high school almost every ELA standard is met. Coverage map ↗

2. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Language is the thread that never fully catches up.** It is the thinnest strand in every band (10%, 45%, 30%), holds the most standards no grade takes to depth, and 5 of the 19 hand-over gaps start from Grade 4 Language standards. Progressions ↗

3. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Talk is our early strength.** Every Speaking and Listening standard is introduced in Kindergarten and Grade 3, even where nothing reaches depth, and it climbs to 100% in Grades 11 and 12. For students learning English, this could be a natural foundation. Coverage map ↗

4. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Foundational reading stops being "in depth" after Grade 2.** Yet many of our students may still be learning to read in Grades 3 to 5. Phonics and fluency may be taught there below grade level, which the Grade 3 to 5 standards would not show. Coverage map ↗

5. STRANDS AND TOPICS **Grade 9 Writing is mostly introduced, between two strong years.** 15% in depth, against 62% in Grade 8 and 77% in Grade 10. Coverage map ↗

6. STRANDS AND TOPICS **The SAT road in ELA is well built at the top.** Reading (61%) and Writing (54%) are strong in high school. Language conventions (30%) may be the area where the SAT asks for more than we currently take to depth. Coverage map ↗

7. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **The build is not a straight line.** Grade 2 (71%) is followed by Grade 3 (0%) and Grade 4 (7%). Grade 8 (50%) is followed by Grade 9 (33%). The Grade 9 dip follows the move to high school. The Grade 3 dip has no such change, which makes it worth a closer look. Coverage map ↗

8. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Middle school is where progressions strain.** Twelve of 29 progressions break down in Grades 6 to 8, usually where a middle school standard in depth builds on a K-5 step rated not taught. Reading and research skills (text features, evidence for claims, inquiry projects) recur. Progressions ↗

9. ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS **Grades 9 and 10 look like a two-year sequence.** They rate the same 43 standards but agree on only 18: Grade 9 introduces and Grade 10 deepens. Grades 11 and 12 rate all 47 shared standards identically. Coverage map ↗

10. PRIORITY AND POWER STANDARDS **Power standards are not yet secure in K-5.** Kindergarten names 47 power standards; the team has not yet rated any of them in depth, and 62% are not taught yet. In secondary the picture reverses: priorities are in depth more often than ELA as a whole. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

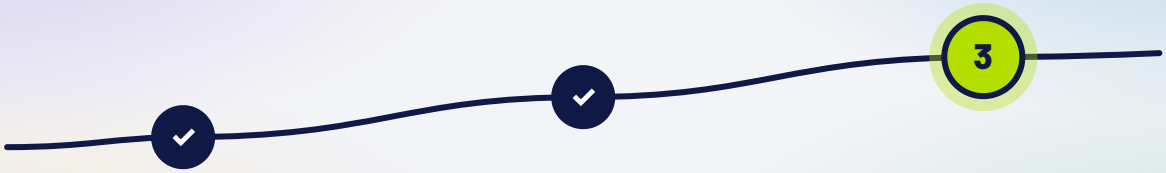
11. ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS **Grade 3 may be teaching more than its rating shows.** The team kept "in depth" for its Essential Elements (66%) rather than for the grade-level standards. Writing and Speaking and Listening are introduced in full. Grade 3 dashboard ↗

12. ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS **Kindergarten and Grade 4 rated few standards in depth at either level.** Their Essential Elements are also rarely in depth (8% and 6%). That sets them apart from Grade 3 and suggests a different explanation, perhaps a stricter reading or a different planning approach. Coverage map ↗

13. CAPACITY AND CHOICES **Capacity shows what a grade carries in ELA each year.** A grade takes about 17 ELA standards to depth a year, introduces about 22 and does not teach about 11, out of about 50 rated. In K-5 it is about 11 of 57, in middle school 23 of 44, in high school 23 of 45. As shares of ELA standards: K-5 19% in depth, 51% introduced, 29% not taught; 6-8 53% in depth, 29% introduced, 18% not taught; 9-12 51% in depth, 42% introduced, 8% not taught. Capacity here means how many standards a grade's teaching time actually holds in a year. It is not a target and not a judgement. Coverage map ↗

14. LITERACY ACROSS SUBJECTS **Literacy is also taught in Science and Social Studies.** These are ELA teams' ratings of ELA lessons. Vocabulary, academic language, speaking and writing are also taught in Science and Social Studies, so ELA standards such as Language and informational reading may be taught more than this part shows. The 2026 literacy audit found about two-fifths of vocabulary teaching, speaking and non-fiction outside the literacy block. Coverage map ↗

15. BACKGROUND **Background from the literacy audit of weekly plans.** That audit found grammar and vocabulary instruction regular in only one or two elementary grades. The ratings agree: Language is the strand most often introduced and never taken to depth.
Gaps and repetition ↗



SECTION 3 OF 3

Where do we go next?

What you are seeing. Questions for teams to talk about. Each one shows the data that prompted it, and links to where that figure appears on this page.

What it adds to our story. These questions are about sharing what works in ELA and deciding who takes Language to depth.

1 **STRANDS AND TOPICS** What happens in Grade 2 and Grade 7 ELA that we could describe, share and repeat?

(Data: Grade 2 is 71% in depth, with Writing 100%; Grade 7 is 70%, with Reading 89%) see Key fact 1

Coverage map ↗

2 **STRANDS AND TOPICS** How do Grades 3 to 5 keep teaching foundational reading for students who still need it, and how could the ratings show that work?

(Data: Reading Foundational Skills is 80% in depth in Grade 2 and 0% in Grades 3, 4 and 5) see Key fact 6

Grade 2 dashboard ↗

3 **STRANDS AND TOPICS** What would help Grade 9 Writing pick up where Grade 8 leaves off?

(Data: Writing in depth is 62% in Grade 8, 15% in Grade 9 and 77% in Grade 10) see Pattern 5

Coverage map ↗

4 **STRANDS AND TOPICS** How might ELA's strengths in reading, writing and discussion carry Social Studies and Science content?

(Data: Secondary ELA is over 50% in depth while Social Studies is 3%) see Key fact 1

Coverage map ↗

1 **STRANDS AND TOPICS** What would a shared K-12 picture of "a strong writer at Awsaj" look like at Grades 2, 5, 8 and 12?

(Data: Writing in depth is 100% in Grade 2, 15% in Grade 5, 62% in Grade 8 and 60% in Grade 12) see Pattern 5

Coverage map ↗

2 **STRANDS AND TOPICS** Which ELA standards are already taught in Science and Social Studies units, and should those teams rate them too?

(Data: Language is 10% in depth in K-5; Social Studies is 4% in depth, Science 35%) see Key fact 5

Coverage map ↗

3 **ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS** What would a Kindergarten to Grade 2 sequence look like that turns strong talk into early reading and writing?

(Data: ELA in depth rises 0%, 21%, 71% from Kindergarten to Grade 2; every Kindergarten Speaking and Listening standard is introduced) see Key fact 1

Coverage map ↗

4 **ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS** Which Grade 4 and Grade 5 Language and Reading standards does Grade 6 most rely on?

(Data: 12 hand-over gaps start in Grades 4 and 5; 5 of them start from Grade 4 Language standards) see Key fact 1

Progressions ↗

1 **ACROSS GRADES AND SCHOOLS** Which research and inquiry skills should be secure by the end of Grade 8, and which subject teaches them?

(Data: The Reading 7 and 8 and Writing 7 and 9 progressions, on text features, evidence and inquiry, break down in middle school)

Progressions ↗

2 **ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS** How did Kindergarten and Grade 4 decide between "introduced" and "in depth", and would a shared example change any ratings?

(Data: In depth, main standards and Essential Elements: Kindergarten 0% and 8%, Grade 4 7% and 6%, Grade 3 0% and 66%, Grade 2 71% and 73%) see Key fact 1

Coverage map ↗

3 **GAPS AND PLACEMENT** **Who owns Language (grammar, conventions, vocabulary) in each band, and how is it taught: on its own, or through reading and writing?**

(Data: Language is 10%, 45% and 30% in depth by band; it holds 50 of 128 confirmed gaps and 84 of 241 introduced-only standards) see Key fact 5

Gaps and repetition ↗

4 **GAPS AND PLACEMENT** **If each grade marked, in one meeting, the ELA standards it introduces on purpose and never needs to take to depth, would the list be the same across the band?**

(Data: 44% of ELA ratings are introduced; 241 standards are introduced and never in depth) see Key fact 13

Gaps and repetition ↗

1 **CAPACITY AND CHOICES** **Are our K-5 power standards the ones we would truly protect, and is 47 in Kindergarten the right number?**

(Data: 18% of 210 K-5 ELA power standard ratings are in depth; Kindergarten rates none of its 47 in depth and 62% not taught) see Pattern 10

Priority and power (Audit) ↗

2 **CAPACITY AND CHOICES** **A K-5 grade rates about 57 ELA standards and takes about 11 to depth: which 11 matter most for students learning English?**

(Data: Per grade: K-5 11 of 57 in depth, 6-8 23 of 44, 9-12 23 of 45) see Pattern 13

Coverage map ↗

3 **CAPACITY AND CHOICES** **Which ELA standards do we introduce on purpose, which need to move to in depth, and what could we leave out to make room?**

(Data: ELA mix: 35% in depth, 44% introduced, 21% not taught) see Key fact 1

Coverage map ↗

Our part in the story

What you are seeing. Options for what we could do, under four headings, each with the data behind it.

What it adds to our story. This is where findings turn into action: small, shared steps we could take together.

Options to discuss and act on. Pick what fits your team, change it, or add your own.

Improving the curriculum

In each band, we could decide how Language (grammar, conventions, vocabulary) is taught: on its own, or through reading and writing.

(Data: Language is 10%, 45% and 30% in depth by band; it holds 84 introduced-only standards) **see Key fact 5**

Coverage map ↗

Working across grade levels

We might ask Grade 2 and Grade 7, our 2 ELA peaks, to share how they plan to depth with the grades around them.

(Data: Grade 2 71% and Grade 7 70% in depth; Grade 3 0% and Grade 9 33%) **see Key fact 1**

Coverage map ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

We could help Grades 4 and 5 learn which Reading and Language standards Grade 6 relies on most.

(Data: 12 hand-over gaps start in Grades 4 and 5; 5 of them start from Grade 4 Language standards) **see Key fact 1**

Progressions ↗

A concrete action we could take

We might build a K-12 picture of "a strong writer at Awsaj" at Grades 2, 5, 8 and 12, with one shared piece of work each.

(Data: Writing in depth: Grade 2 100%, Grade 5 15%, Grade 8 62%, Grade 12 60%) **see Pattern 5**

Coverage map ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

About the data

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Key facts, Relevant patterns, and Where do we go next? (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

> **These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers.** They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

ABOUT THE DATA

How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Key facts, Relevant patterns, and Where do we go next? (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

Where the numbers come from. Every figure is computed from the ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings, last rating 8 November) and checked against the Vertical Alignment reports and findings decks.

The three ratings.

Rating	What it means
Taught in depth	ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard
Introduced / exposed	Anything in between: some classes, or taught briefly (for example, 3 of 5 classes)

Rating	What it means
Not taught	No class in the grade teaches it

Four things to hold in mind while reading.

- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught across a whole grade. They are not a measure of what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read that more or less strictly, so a low figure can reflect a stricter reading, not less teaching. Where this matters most, the paper says so. Where a team rated nothing in depth, we read it as careful use of an all-or-nothing scale, not as an absence of teaching.
- Each team rated its own subject's standards. Much literacy (vocabulary, academic language, speaking, writing, reading non-fiction) is also taught through Science and Social Studies, and that teaching may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of the main grade-level ratings (one standard in one grade). Essential Elements (the alternate standards) are counted apart.

We cannot teach everything equally. No school can take every standard to depth, and that is not the goal. The goal is to choose on purpose: which standards we teach in depth, which we introduce, and which we leave out, and to plan that proportion together across the grades. The ratings show the mix we have now, so we can decide the mix we want.

Instructional capacity. How many standards a grade actually takes to depth, introduces or leaves out in a year, worked out from the ratings (the average for one grade). It is not a target and not a judgement: it describes what our teaching time holds now, so we can decide together how to use it.

Themes. In every part, the facts, patterns and questions are grouped under the same themes, in the same order: The big picture, Strands and topics, Across grades and schools, Priority and power standards, Essential Elements, Gaps and placement, How we read the scale, Capacity and choices, Literacy across subjects and Background. Each item shows its theme, so a team can follow one theme across the whole school, its band and its subject.

How each part is laid out. Three sections, each opening with a small map that shows where you are: Key facts, then Relevant patterns, then Where do we go next? (questions to ponder, then options for our part in the story: improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). Every pattern carries its figures in the text, and every question ends with the data behind it, in brackets and italics. The questions are invitations, not conclusions. Our strengths are named alongside the places where we might build.

ABOUT THE DATA

Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

What was read

Source	How it was used	How fully it was read
Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026)	Every figure	All 2,166 rows
Organized ratings workbook	Cross-check of totals	All tabs
20 Findings decks (band and subject)	Cross-check, questions and next-step themes	All slides and speaker notes
K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages)	Cross-check	First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly
7 other Reports PDFs	Cross-check of headline figures	Scanned by search, not read page by page

How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **No grade teaches it (confirmed).** Every grade that could teach the standard rated it not taught.
- **Not taught where placed.** The grade it was placed in rated it not taught, and other grades that could teach it were not asked.
- **Introduced, never in depth (met but not owned).** Introduced in at least one grade and in depth in none.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.
- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.

- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Instructional capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

Limits to keep in view

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught. They do not measure what students know or can do.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school standards were placed in grades and courses by suggestion. "Not taught" there can mean "taught in another year". 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also not taught in the grade where they were placed.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.
- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

Status. This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.